

Duke University  
Master of Economics  
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## Education

Master of Economics, Duke University, Durham, United States, 2025–2027.

Bachelor of Economics, Finance, Dongbei University of Finance and Economics, Dalian, China, 2021–2025.  
GPA: 3.81/4.00, 89.75/100. Selected coursework: Probability Theory and Mathematical Statistics (97), Operations Research (94), C Programming (94), Data Mining (98), Econometrics I & II (94).

Summer School, Shanghai Jiao Tong University, Shanghai, China, May–July 2023.

Coursework: Statistical Inference (A), Introduction to Statistical Learning (A-).

## Research

### Working Papers

1. [Kan Xu](#) and Zixi Zhou. “Joint Multitask Transfer Learning for Linear Recourse Bandits”

Develops a joint estimator for a shared dense component and row-sparse task heterogeneity. Establishes near-minimax rates under collective identification, even when some source tasks are not identified on their own. Uses sparse target correction to construct confidence sets and regret guarantees for sequential decisions.

2. Zixi Zhou. “Own-Cluster Reuse Bias in Orthogonal Panel Estimation”

Orthogonal scores remove first-order sensitivity to globally estimated nuisance functions, but not necessarily bias from a unit coordinate estimated and evaluated with the same dependent cluster. We call this *own-cluster reuse*. In a partially linear panel model, an exact fixed-sieve expansion separates two drift terms of order  $T^{-1}$ : derivative–influence covariance and curvature. Either can shift the  $\sqrt{NT}$  limit when  $N/T$  approaches a positive constant. For a sample-mean coordinate and growing tensor-product spline sieve, we estimate both long-run terms while retaining the full unit history and construct a cluster long-run variance estimator. Under independent units, deterministic quasi-uniform coordinates, and bounded fixed-range within-unit dependence, the correction restores asymptotic linearity and standard-normal studentization. Buffered within-unit splitting removes covariance but leaves—and under an equal split doubles—curvature. In a nonlinear  $N = T = 200$  design, correction reduces  $\sqrt{NT}$ -scaled bias from 0.744 to 0.008 and yields 95.9% coverage.

### Work in Progress

1. [Yutao Sun](#) and Zixi Zhou. “Panel Quantile Regression with Heterogeneous Slope Coefficients”

Develops a smoothed panel quantile framework with heterogeneous slopes and multi-way fixed effects. Derives analytical incidental-parameter bias corrections for static and dynamic models.

2. Qinzhi Zeng and Zixi Zhou. “False Group Reputations and Strategic Performance”

## Awards

Duke Economics Master’s Scholar Award, four academic terms.

Multiple Third-Class Scholarship, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024.

## Skills

Programming: Python, Matlab, C, R.

Languages: Mandarin (native), English.